Gemcitabine and cisplatin · lung cancer

To slow or shrink advanced lung cancer and help control symptoms. Your team will explain the aim for you.

Your treatment plan

Every 3 weeks: gemcitabine and cisplatin on Day 1, then gemcitabine alone on Day 8. Usually 4–6 cycles, with a review before each dose.

1. **Prepare**
Agree the treatment aim, planned number of cycles, blood tests and contact numbers.

2. **Treatment**
Day 1: both medicines. Day 8: gemcitabine only. Then time at home before the next cycle.

3. **Review**
Your team checks symptoms, scans and side effects to agree what happens next.

Before and between visits

- Bring your medicines list and report any new symptoms.
- Confirm blood tests and the anti-sickness tablets to take at home.
- Ask for the daytime and out-of-hours oncology numbers before leaving.

When to get help

Call 112 / **999** for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately for temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions.

Cannot reach the team? Seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Your contact plan

Ask your team to complete these before you leave.

Hospital / team _____

Daytime number and hours _____

Evening / weekend number _____

If unavailable, where to go _____

Keep this with your consent information. Ask your team about anything unclear.

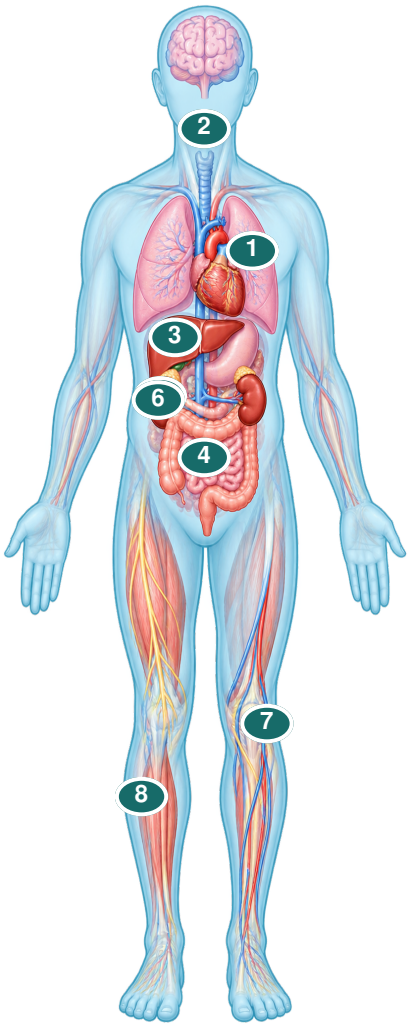
SACTCheck · v0.84.28 · Source: NCCP 00281 v7. Feasibility build: independent clinical and patient review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

What to watch for

Use the picture and symptom descriptions together. You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

1. Breathing
Gemcitabine
Call urgently for new cough or breathlessness.

2. Mouth
Chemotherapy
Report painful sores or difficulty eating and drinking.



3. Liver
Gemcitabine
Blood tests check liver function; report yellow eyes or dark urine.

4. Sickness / bowels
Chemotherapy
Follow the anti-sickness plan; call if unable to keep fluids down.

5. Kidneys / urine
Cisplatin / gemcitabine
Report reduced urine or new swelling; keep kidney blood tests.

6. Blood / infection
Chemotherapy
Fever, sudden illness or unusual bleeding needs urgent advice.

7. Skin
Gemcitabine
Report widespread rash, blistering or peeling urgently.

8. Nerves / hearing
Cisplatin
Report numbness, tingling, ringing ears or hearing changes.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Match each number to its symptom box. Blood, skin and nerve markers are schematic.

Call your oncology team immediately for fever or suddenly feeling unwell, shaking chills, new breathlessness, chest pain, unusual bleeding, very little urine, severe rash or blistering, or vomiting that stops you keeping fluids down. Use your unit's temperature threshold and emergency instructions. Do not wait until the next visit.

My systemic anticancer therapy (SACT) card

Gemcitabine and cisplatin · lung cancer
21-day cycle: gemcitabine + cisplatin Day 1; gemcitabine Day 8.

Receiving chemotherapy: fever or sudden illness can be an emergency. Contact oncology urgently; do not wait for the next visit.

Name: _____
Hospital: _____
Oncology phone: _____
Out of hours: _____

Show this card when seeking care. It does not replace a medicine-specific alert card.

More information, when you want it

Scan for medicines, tests, daily life and your treatment record.

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00281/